

Yacht Management & Marine Services

Freedom To enjoy

MARINE HQ

CREW HIRING PACK 1 OF 6

Write the job first

Before you speak to a single candidate, write down the boat, the programme and the role. It is the brief every good hire starts from.

Boat: _____ Prepared by: _____ Date: _____ Role: _____

1 ABOUT THE BOAT

- [ ] **The boat**
  Make, length, age, home port. Engines and generators. Anything unusual: stabilisers, tender garage, passerelle.
- [ ] **How she is used**
  Days a year aboard. Day trips, overnight, long cruising. Does she ever charter? Where does she go in a season?
- [ ] **Who is already aboard**
  Existing crew, a management company, regular trades. Who the new person reports to, and who covers them.
- [ ] **Where she lives**
  Marina, berth number, nearest town. Is the crew member expected to live aboard or nearby?

2 ABOUT THE JOB

- [ ] **The role and the level**
  Captain, engineer, mate, deckhand, steward/ess or chef. Junior or experienced. Permanent, seasonal, relief or delivery.
- [ ] **Hours, days and leave**
  Typical week and busy weeks. Days off. Annual leave and who covers it.
- [ ] **Licences and tickets you require**
  Write the certificate by name. If she is chartered or hired out, her master needs the right AMSA certificate; ask your insurer what they require as well.
- [ ] **What you will pay**
  Base pay, superannuation on top, uniform, travel and food. Decide the range before you speak to anyone.
- [ ] **How long, and the start date**
  Permanent or fixed term. Probation period. The date you need them aboard.
- [ ] **The things that will be a problem**
  Early starts, rotating rosters, living aboard, smoking, pets, children aboard. Say them early.

NOTES decisions made, and the pay range you have set

Prepared by: _____ Date: _____

Find and screen

Where crew come from, and what to check on the CV before you spend an hour on an interview.

3 WHERE TO FIND CREW

- [ ] **A crewing agency**
  Ask for the fee schedule, the replacement guarantee and the checks they run, in writing, before you sign a letter of engagement.
- [ ] **Your management company**
  If a manager runs the boat, ask them to run the search, the paperwork and the handover.
- [ ] **A job board**
  Australian yacht job boards list roles and take applications. You screen, interview, check and do the paperwork.
- [ ] **Daywork first**
  Try a strong candidate for a few days at the dock or on a delivery before you offer a full-time role.
- [ ] **Word of mouth**
  Other captains, the marina, the yard. A reference from someone you trust is worth more than a CV.

4 SCREEN THE CV BEFORE YOU MEET

- [ ] **CV is current and honest**
  Dates add up. Boats, sizes and roles are named. No unexplained gaps longer than a few months.
- [ ] **Certificates in date**
  Ask for copies. Read the issue and expiry dates yourself.
- [ ] **Medical certificate current**
  A certificate of medical fitness for seafarers is part of the usual starting kit.
- [ ] **Right to work in Australia**
  Citizen, permanent resident or a visa that lets them work. A yacht crew member usually needs a visa other than the Maritime Crew visa; ask before you make an offer.
- [ ] **Photo, phone number and two referees**
  Referees who ran the boats they worked on, not friends.
- [ ] **A short first call**
  Ten minutes, before any interview: availability, pay expectation, why they are leaving the last boat.

Agency fee models published by one industry guide: permanent placement 8% to 10% of annual salary, or 75% to 100% of a month's pay; seasonal 70% to 80% of a gross month; temporary 25% to 30% of the daily rate. Guarantees run from 60 days to the end of the probation period. The yacht normally pays the fee, not the crew member. Terms differ; get yours in writing.

CANDIDATES who you found, where from, and who goes forward

NAME	SOURCE	ROLE	GO FORWARD?

Reviewed by: _____ Date: _____

Interview questions

The same questions for every candidate, by role. Write the answers down.

1 CAPTAIN OR MASTER

- [ ] Tell me about the largest boat you have run, and what the programme was.
- [ ] What did you do in your first month on your last boat?
- [ ] Describe a day when something broke at sea. What did you do?
- [ ] How do you plan maintenance and the yard period? Who do you use for trades?
- [ ] How do you keep the owner informed about cost and condition?
- [ ] What do you hand over when you leave a boat?

2 ENGINEER

- [ ] What engines and generators have you worked on, and to what hours?
- [ ] How do you run a planned maintenance schedule? Show me one you kept.
- [ ] A temperature alarm sounds under load. Walk me through it.
- [ ] What do you log, and how often?
- [ ] Which jobs do you do yourself, and which do you hand to a specialist?

3 DECKHAND OR BOSUN

- [ ] What is your experience washing and polishing gelcoat, teak and stainless?
- [ ] Show me how you would bring a boat alongside in a crosswind, as the person on the line.
- [ ] What have you done on a boat when no one was watching?
- [ ] How do you handle a long day, a short night and a guest who is unhappy?
- [ ] What courses do you hold and when do they expire?

4 STEWARD/ESS OR CHEF

- [ ] Describe how you run a guest cabin turnaround, step by step.
- [ ] What laundry and fabric care do you know: silk, linen, teak, leather?
- [ ] How do you provision for a week and keep the stores in order?
- [ ] What would you do if the owner's guest has an allergy you were not told about?
- [ ] Why yachting, and what do you want from the next two years?

Listen for specifics. A good candidate names boats, sizes, systems and dates. Ask for the example, then the detail behind it. Ask the same questions of every candidate and write the answers down; it is the only fair way to compare them.

INTERVIEW NOTES

candidate, date, what they said, how you would rate it

Interviewer: _____ Date: _____

References and certificates

Call the last two captains or owners. A written reference tells you nothing a phone call will not.

1 REFERENCE CALL: SIX QUESTIONS

- [ ] Confirm the dates they worked, the role and the boat.
- [ ] What were they responsible for?
- [ ] How did they handle pressure, a mistake or a conflict?
- [ ] Were they on time, reliable and honest, including with the maintenance record?
- [ ] Why did they leave?
- [ ] Would you employ them again? What would you want me to watch for?

2 WHAT TO ASK TO SEE, BY ROLE

- [ ] **Captain**
  Master certificate for the size and use of the boat; first aid; safety training; medical. Ask to see sea-time records.
- [ ] **Engineer**
  Engine certificate to the grade the role needs; safety training; medical; service records for the engines they have run.
- [ ] **Deckhand or mate**
  Safety training; powerboat or coxswain ticket if they drive the tender; medical.
- [ ] **Steward/ess or chef**
  Safety training; first aid; food safety if they cook; hospitality references.

3 REFERENCE RECORD write what each referee says

CANDIDATE	REFEREE AND BOAT	WOULD EMPLOY AGAIN?	NOTES
Candidate 1			
Candidate 2			
Candidate 3			

CERTIFICATES SEEN what you saw, issue and expiry dates

DOCUMENT	NUMBER	ISSUED	EXPIRES

Checked by: _____ Date: _____

CREW HIRING PACK 5 OF 6

The offer and the paperwork

A written agreement, the real cost of the hire and the rules to check before the start date.

1 BEFORE THE OFFER: PAPERWORK

- [ ] A written employment agreement, signed by both of you before the start date
- [ ] Pay, superannuation, leave, hours and rest set out in it
- [ ] Probation period stated, and how long
- [ ] Notice period for both sides
- [ ] WorkCover and the insurance that covers paid crew arranged
- [ ] Uniform, travel, food and accommodation set out
- [ ] Right to work confirmed and a copy on file
- [ ] Tax file number and superannuation details collected
- [ ] Duties, reporting line and who covers leave written down
- [ ] Which award or agreement applies checked with an adviser

2 WHAT THIS HIRE REALLY COSTS IN YEAR ONE fill in your own figures

ITEM	YOUR FIGURE
Base salary	
Superannuation, 12% of base	
WorkCover premium, at your rate	
Agency fee, if used	
Cover for four weeks' leave	
Flights, uniform and training	
First-year total	

Rules to check, not guess. The superannuation guarantee rate is 12% from 1 July 2025. Industry guidance is at least 10 hours of rest in any 24 and four weeks of paid leave a year. Which award or agreement applies to private-yacht crew is a question for an employment adviser. If a firm supplies you its own staff by the day, ask whether it holds a Queensland labour hire licence; the register is public.

OFFER TERMS pay, start date, probation, leave, notice

Offered by: _____ Date: _____

Handover and first month

A handover record that stays with the boat, and three reviews that decide whether the placement works.

1 FIRST-WEEK HANDOVER LIST

- [ ] Open defects list: every known fault and its status
- [ ] Maintenance schedule and the last service dates
- [ ] Engine and generator hours, and when each is next due
- [ ] Contacts: trades, the yard, the marina, the insurer, the surveyor
- [ ] Certificates, registration and insurance: where the originals are
- [ ] Passwords, codes and where keys are kept
- [ ] How she is brought alongside in a wind, and any quirks
- [ ] Stores, spares and where each is kept

2 PROBATION REVIEW: TICK AT 30, 60 AND 90 DAYS

- [ ] Settled in: knows the boat, the schedule and the people
- [ ] Reports problems early and in writing
- [ ] Maintenance record kept up to date
- [ ] Reliable, on time and easy to work with
- [ ] Owner or manager confident to confirm the role

3 REVIEW LOG date, what was agreed

DATE	REVIEW (30, 60, 90)	AGREED ACTIONS
Review 1		
Review 2		
Review 3		

The first month decides it. Agree the review dates before the start date, write down what good looks like, and keep the handover record with the boat, not with the person. If you would rather have a team find, check and place the right person, Marine HQ places crew across Australia: 0439 748 387.

NOTES what was agreed, what needs attention

Reviewed by: _____ Date: _____

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